Supervisor briefing — update since the fifth meeting (8 October 2026)

Can a soundtrack's emotion predict a film's genre? This page covers what was done after the fifth meeting: the four notes, a data error found while answering the second one, and what both changed. The briefing for the fourth meeting is archived in `docs/archive/current_state_2026-10-07.md`; every earlier round is in `briefing_full.md`, and every experiment in detail in the technical log, `docs/README.md` (section 24 for this round). The thesis on Overleaf is up to date with everything below.

All genre scores are **film-level macro-F1** (the clip probabilities of a film are averaged and the film is scored once); the clip-level value of the same predictions is given where it matters.

1. Your notes from the meeting

Your four notes from 8 October, as written down after the meeting:

1. "Blockbuster cross validation (bar chart is ok, but with SD)"
2. "Common films between Eerola and Blockbuster should be considered in the Evaluation part (leakage)"
3. "Each genre: F1-score, precision and recall; check the highest model for each genre and maybe make a diagram out of the results"
4. "More focus in the Evaluation part on only a couple of results, so the reader is not distracted; be more precise in the Discussion and the whole thesis"

#	Your note	What was done	Result
1	Blockbuster cross-validation as a bar chart, but with SD	Two bar charts with error bars (section 3)	Blockbuster in-domain: the routes are level; across datasets the error bars show how much a single split can move
2	Films common to Eerola and Blockbuster (leakage)	Checked every IMDb id and title (section 4)	**No film is in both datasets.** But inside Eerola **one film was counted twice** — fixed, and every Eerola result re-run (section 2)
3	F1, precision and recall per genre; the best model per genre; a diagram	Per-genre heatmap and table (section 5)	The emotion route is best on Action, Crime and Comedy; MIR on Drama; CLAP on Horror
4	Focus the Evaluation on a few results; be more precise in the Discussion	Evaluation rebuilt around the core results, the rest in a new Appendix A; Discussion shortened (section 6)	Evaluation 990 → about 530 lines, Discussion 340 → about 200

2. A data error found while checking note 2

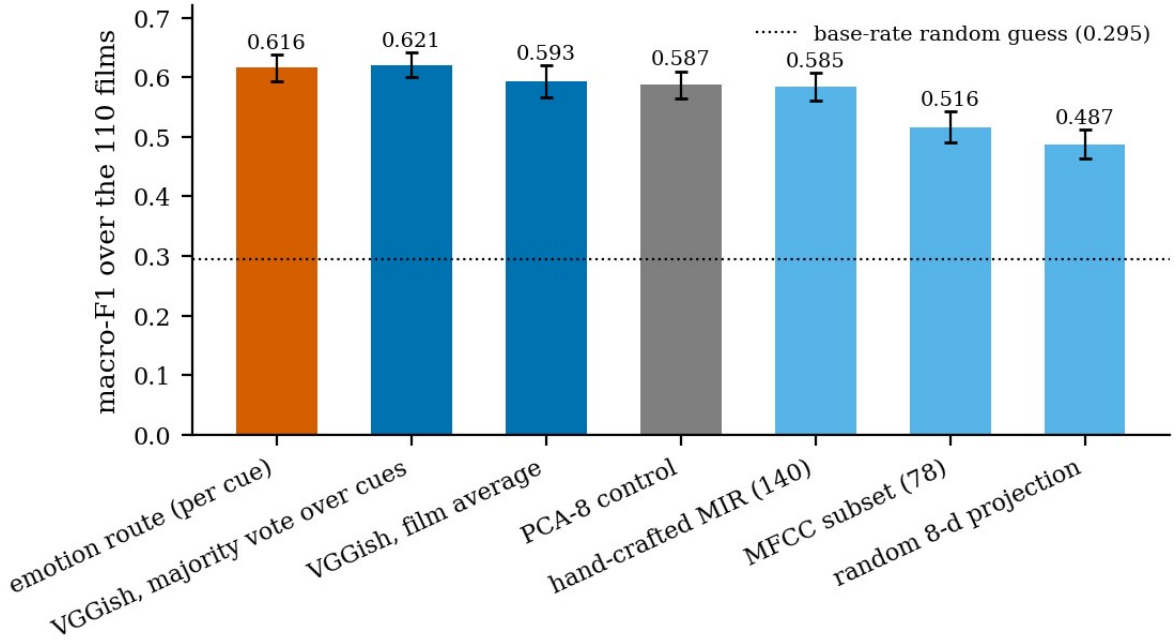
Eerola clip 256 is labelled **"The Portait of a Lady"** (a typo), the film's six other clips **"The Portrait of a Lady"** — the same film (same IMDb id). Every split groups clips by this name, so the film counted as two films and one of its clips could be tested while the other six were in training: a small leak, and wrong film counts everywhere.

- **Fixed in the loader** (the two spellings are merged); the dataset has **42 films** on eight genres and **40** on five, not 43 and 41; clips per film range from 2 to 18.

- **Every Eerola experiment that groups by film was re-run** (16 scripts, about two hours). Each re-run reproduced the one before it exactly, so the changes come from the grouping alone.
- The numbers moved by about the size of the split noise (0.01 to 0.03), because merging the two names changes which films land in which fold. Some conclusions changed with them (section 7).

3. Note 1 — bar charts with SD

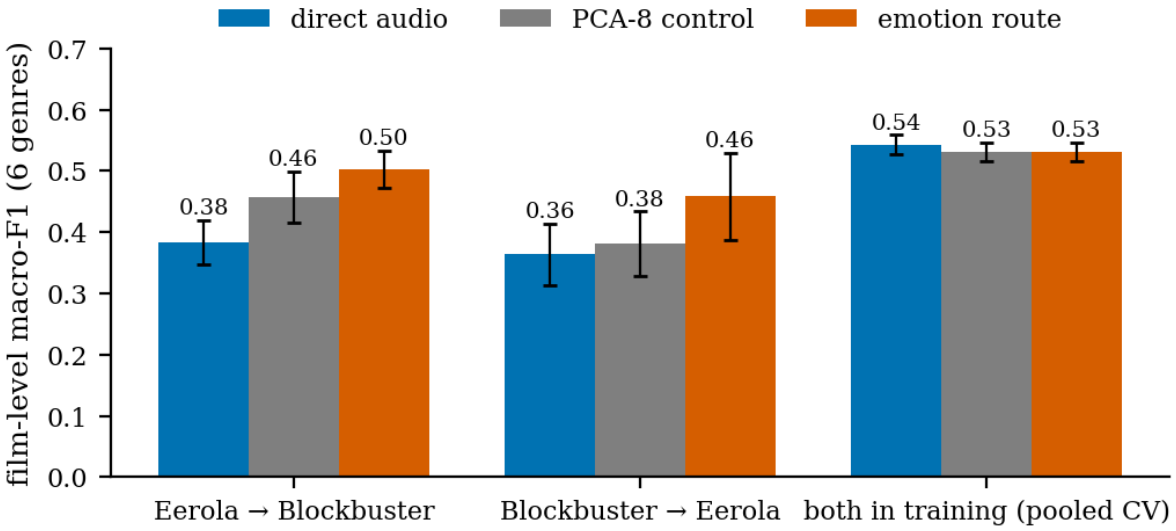
Blockbuster in-domain (10×5 cross-validation over the 110 films; error bars = SD of the 10 repeat means):



Blockbuster in-domain cross-validation

The emotion route (0.616 ± 0.022) is level with direct audio: VGGish film average 0.593 ± 0.028 (Nadeau–Bengio p = 0.536), VGGish with a majority vote over cues 0.621 ± 0.020, PCA-8 0.587, hand-crafted MIR 0.585; random guess 0.295.

Across datasets (error bars: bootstrap SD over the test films for the two transfer directions, SD of the 5 repeat means for the pooled design):



The three cross-dataset designs

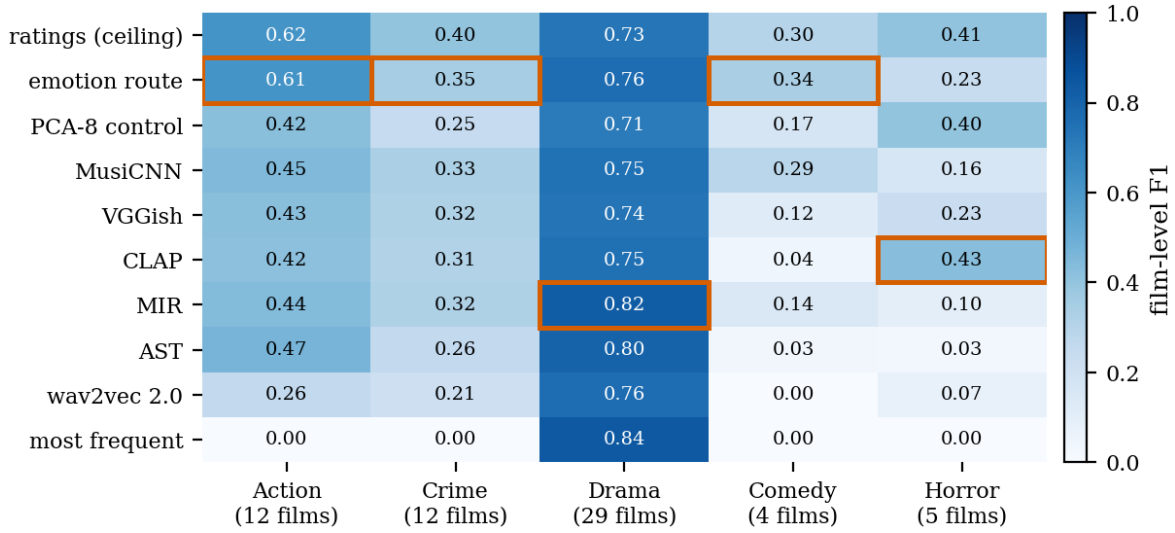
design	emotion	PCA-8	direct	emotion – direct
Eerola → Blockbuster (re-implementation)	0.503 ± 0.030	0.457	0.383 ± 0.037	+0.121, p = 0.007
Blockbuster → Eerola, 40 films	0.458 ± 0.071	0.381	0.364 ± 0.050	+0.089, **p = 0.102**
both in training (pooled, per film)	0.531 ± 0.015	0.531	0.543 ± 0.016	-0.011, p = 0.688

The error bars of a single transfer split are large (about ±0.03 to ±0.07), which is why the comparisons rest on the paired bootstrap rather than on the bars overlapping or not.

4. Note 2 — leakage between the datasets

- **No common film.** None of the 42 Eerola films' IMDb ids occurs among the 110 Blockbuster films, and no title matches (also not loosely). The Eerola films are all from before 2011, the Blockbuster films from 2014 to 2019.
- **Shared composers, not shared films.** Some composers scored films in both, e.g. Danny Elfman (*Batman* in Eerola, *Justice League* in Blockbuster, which quotes his Batman theme). That is stylistic overlap, not a leak; the thesis names it as a limitation.
- **The leak that did exist was inside Eerola** (section 2), and it is fixed.

5. Note 3 — results per genre



Film-level F1 per genre and route; the best route per genre is boxed

genre	films	best route (F1)	emotion route P / R / F1	VGGish P / R / F1
Action	12	emotion route (0.61)	0.52 / 0.76 / **0.61**	0.39 / 0.47 / 0.43
Crime	12	emotion route (0.35)	0.28 / 0.47 / **0.35**	0.29 / 0.37 / 0.32
Drama	29	MIR (0.82)	0.87 / 0.68 / **0.76**	0.79 / 0.69 / 0.74
Comedy	4	emotion route (0.34)	0.22 / 0.78 / **0.34**	0.12 / 0.12 / 0.12
Horror	5	CLAP (0.43)	0.15 / 0.50 / **0.23**	0.21 / 0.26 / 0.23

- The emotion route is the **best route for Action, Crime and Comedy**; the hand-crafted MIR features are best on Drama and CLAP on Horror.
- Its advantage is mostly **recall on the rare genres**: averaged over the five genres recall 0.64 vs 0.38 for VGGish, at precision 0.41 vs 0.36. Comedy is the clearest case (recall 0.78 vs 0.12).

- **Horror is the exception**: the emotion route finds half the Horror films but predicts the genre for too many others (precision 0.15).
- With 4 Comedy and 5 Horror films, one film moves a genre's F1 by about 0.2: this is a description, not a test.

6. Note 4 — a focused Evaluation and a more precise Discussion

Main text of Chapter 5 now: Stage 1 (emotion regression, short) → RQ1 → emotion vs direct audio with **one 4-row comparison table** → **results per genre** (new) → emotional signatures and their replication → transfer (Blockbuster in-domain chart, leakage check, zero-shot, the three cross-dataset designs with SD) → a one-page summary.

Moved to the new Appendix A (each with one sentence and a pointer in the main text): all paired comparisons and the Nadeau–Bengio limit, the metric family and the threshold analysis, stability over seeds, the emotion ablation, the waveform representation, all eight genres, the reproduction of Ma et al. with the cue-level analysis, and the error analysis.

Discussion: built around one table of all settings; one paragraph each for the in-domain and the cross-dataset result; the "why" section reduced to meaning vs compression, scarce data and domain shift; limitations as short paragraphs.

7. What changed in the numbers (before → after the duplicate fix)

	before	after
emotion route, 5 genres (film level)	0.469	**0.460**
ratings (ceiling)	0.521	0.491
direct VGGish / best direct (MusiCNN)	0.375 / 0.385	0.367 / 0.396
PCA-8 control	0.418	0.390
emotion vs VGGish (film bootstrap)	+0.095, p = 0.047	+0.093, **p = 0.052**
emotion vs PCA-8	+0.051, p = 0.326	+0.070, p = 0.089
predicted vs rated emotion	−0.053, p = 0.053	-0.032, p = 0.277
8 genres: emotion vs VGGish	+0.096, p = 0.002	+0.093, p = 0.001
zero-shot: emotion vs direct	0.511 vs 0.407, p = 0.018	0.508 vs 0.403, p = 0.013
Blockbuster → Eerola (per film)	+0.077, p = 0.127	+0.089, p = 0.102
Stage 1, best R^2	0.561	0.558

What this changes in the thesis.

- In-domain, the emotion route is still ahead of every direct representation in nearly every repeat and under every seed, but its lead is now significant only against the weaker ones (AST, hand-crafted MIR, wav2vec 2.0). Against VGGish it **just misses** (p = 0.052), against CLAP, MusiCNN and PCA-8 it is not significant.
- **Film level is the stricter unit.** Over clips the film bootstrap finds the lead significant against VGGish, CLAP, MusiCNN and PCA-8; over films it does not. So the film-level choice does not favour the method — the thesis says so.
- The zero-shot result is unchanged in substance; the cross-dataset conclusions stand.

8. Open items

1. **Write the held-back parts** (abstract, Chapter 7, contributions). The drafts in `docs/latex/held_back/` quote numbers from before the film-level switch *and* the fix; use section 7 above.
2. **Read Chapters 5, 6 and Appendix A in full.** They were rebuilt today; the Discussion's interpretation must become your own.
3. **Zero-shot with a threshold tuned on the source dataset** — still not run.

4. **AI declaration**: two red notes and the date.

9. Questions to expect, and the answers

Is the emotion route better in-domain? It is ahead of every direct audio representation (by +0.093 over VGGish, its own input) in 9 or all ten repeats and under every seed, but on 40 films its lead is significant only against the weaker representations; against VGGish p = 0.052. Part of the gain is compression (PCA-8 is also ahead of VGGish under every seed) and part is the default threshold (with tuned thresholds the routes converge, 0.420–0.433 over clips).

What is the main result then? The emotion route is clearly ahead where the classifier is trained on the small Eerola dataset — in-domain and from Eerola to Blockbuster (0.508 vs 0.403, p = 0.013) — and level where it is trained on the 110 Blockbuster films or on both. Its emotional signatures replicate on Blockbuster (r = 0.836).

Could the transfer result come from films that are in both datasets? No: no film is in both (section 4).

Why do the numbers differ from the last meeting? A film was counted twice in Eerola; fixing it changed every split (section 2).

Why is box office not in the thesis? It answers a question about commercial success, not genre: classification quality does not relate to gross (Eerola ρ = +0.197), and the score's emotions relate to it only through the budget (anger ρ = +0.43, budget–gross ρ = +0.78).

10. For the author: what was added, and how to explain it

This section is your preparation, not part of the briefing. For every addition since the fifth meeting: where it is in the thesis, how it was computed, what to say, and where the weak spot is.

10.1 The duplicate film (the change that moved every number)

- **Where:** Chapter 5, Section 5.6 (paragraph "No film occurs in both datasets", last sentences); log section 24; `src/config.py` (`SOUNDTRACK_NAME_FIXES`), applied in `src/features/loader.py`.
- **What happened:** cross-validation groups clips by the soundtrack name so that a film is never in training and test at once. Clip 256 had the typo "The Portait of a Lady", so the grouping saw two films. That one clip could be tested while the film's other six clips were in training.
- **How it was fixed:** the loader maps the misspelt name to the correct one before anything else runs. All 16 film-grouped experiments were then re-run in their dependency order (about two hours). Each script first reproduces the stored numbers of the one before it, so the changes come from the merge alone, not from a code change.
- **What to say:** "While checking the leakage between the datasets I found a leak inside Eerola, fixed it and re-ran everything. The numbers moved by about the size of the split noise; the conclusions changed in one place: the in-domain lead over VGGish went from p = 0.047 to p = 0.052."
- **Weak spot:** the earlier p = 0.047 was "significant", the new p = 0.052 is not. Do not round it; the thesis says it "just misses".

10.2 Note 1: the bar charts with SD

- **Where:** Figure `blockbuster_cv` (Section 5.6.1) and Figure `cross_dataset` (Section 5.6.3), now with error bars; scripts `experiments/make_figures.py`.
- **Blockbuster in-domain chart:** 10×5 cross-validation over the 110 films. Each bar is the mean over the 50 folds; the **error bar is the SD of the ten repeat means**, i.e. how much the result moves when the films are shuffled into different folds. The p-values beside it are Nadeau–Bengio (there are folds here, so that test works).

- **Cross-dataset chart:** a transfer direction is one fixed train–test split, so there are no repeats to take an SD over. Its error bar is the **bootstrap SD over the test films** (draw the test films with replacement 2000 times, rescore, take the SD). For the pooled design, which is cross-validated, it is again the SD of the repeat means.
- **What to say:** "The bars show that a single transfer split can move by ±0.03 to ±0.07, which is why I compare the routes with a paired bootstrap rather than by whether bars overlap."
- **Weak spot:** the two error bars measure different things (fold shuffling vs which films are sampled). The figure text says which is which; if asked, say that.

10.3 Note 2: the leakage check

- **Where:** Chapter 5, Section 5.6, paragraph "No film occurs in both datasets".
- **How:** every Eerola film's IMDb id was compared with the 110 Blockbuster ids, and the titles were compared exactly and loosely (lower case, punctuation removed). Nothing matched. The release years explain why: Eerola before 2011, Blockbuster 2014–2019.
- **What to say:** "No film is in both datasets, so the transfer result cannot come from a shared film. The datasets do share composers, e.g. Danny Elfman (*Batman* / *Justice League*), which is a possible stylistic overlap; I name it as a limitation."

10.4 Note 3: precision, recall and F1 per genre

- **Where:** Chapter 5, Section 5.4: Figure `per_genre` (heatmap) and Table `per_genre`. Numbers in `results/film_level.json` (`per_genre_precision`, `per_genre_recall`, `per_genre_f1` for every route; `clip_per_genre_*` for clip level).
- **How:** the same predictions as the headline. Per repeat, all out-of-fold predictions are pooled, each film gets the average of its clips' probabilities, a genre is predicted at ≥ 0.5, and precision, recall and F1 are computed per genre over the 40 films. These are averaged over the ten repeats. Macro-F1 is simply the mean of the five per-genre F1s.
- **The heatmap:** rows are routes, columns genres; the box marks the best route per genre among the emotion route, PCA-8 and the six direct representations (the ratings and the baseline are shown but not boxed, since they are a ceiling and a floor, not competitors).
- **What to say:** "The emotion route is the best route for Action, Crime and Comedy. Its advantage is mainly recall: it finds the rare genres (Comedy recall 0.78 vs 0.12), at the price of more false positives. Horror is the exception: although fear defines it, the emotion route predicts Horror for too many films."
- **Weak spot:** Comedy has 4 films and Horror 5. One film more or less changes their F1 by about 0.2, so the per-genre comparison is a description, not a test. No p-values are given per genre on purpose.

10.5 Note 4: a focused Evaluation and Discussion

- **Chapter 5 now has seven sections:** 5.1 Stage 1 → 5.2 RQ1 → 5.3 emotion vs direct audio (one table, four comparisons) → 5.4 per genre → 5.5 emotional signatures → 5.6 transfer (Blockbuster in-domain, leakage, zero-shot, three designs) → 5.7 summary.
- **New Appendix A** (`appendix/supplementary.tex`) holds everything that checks a result without changing it: A.1 all paired comparisons and why Nadeau–Bengio stays borderline, A.2 choice of metric and stability, A.3 the emotion ablation, A.4 the waveform model, A.5 all eight genres, A.6 the reproduction of Ma et al. and cue-level prediction, A.7 error analysis. The main text points to each with one sentence.
- **Chapter 6 (Discussion)** is built around one table of all settings. 6.1 interprets the main result, 6.2 explains why the bottleneck helps where it does (meaning vs compression, little data, domain shift), 6.3 limitations, 6.4 prior work.

- **What to say:** "The main text now answers the research questions and nothing else; everything that only confirms a result is in the appendix."

10.6 Background you may be asked about

- **How Stage 1 is evaluated.** A random forest predicts each of the eight emotion ratings from an audio embedding. It is scored by R^2 on out-of-fold predictions of five-fold cross-validation grouped by film, over all 360 rated clips, and averaged over the emotions. $R^2 = 0$ means "as good as always predicting the mean rating"; the best embeddings reach 0.558, i.e. 62 % of the 0.897 at which two independent listener panels agree with each other.
- **What "random guess" means.** The base-rate random guess predicts each genre at random with its frequency in the training data (Drama often, Comedy rarely). It is the fair chance floor for macro-F1 (0.309 on 5 genres). The **most-frequent** baseline decides each genre by its majority in training, so in practice it predicts Drama for every film and never a rare genre; it scores much lower (0.168). Always name which floor you quote.
- **Film level vs clip level.** Film level: average the clip probabilities of a film, then score the film once (the headline). Clip level: score every clip. Film level was chosen after the clip results were known, and the thesis says so; it turned out the *stricter* unit, because over clips more of the comparisons are significant.
- **The two tests.** The film bootstrap resamples films (a test fold holds about 8 films, so a per-fold t-test cannot be computed per film). Nadeau–Bengio is the corrected t-test over folds, used at clip level. It also charges for which films were used for training, so it is the more conservative test. Adding repeats cannot push its p-value below a floor (p_lim); for every borderline comparison of the emotion route that floor is 0.069 to 0.200 (Appendix A.1). Only more films could make those comparisons significant.

Headline numbers as they stand

Each row is its own label space, compared only against its own chance level:

setting	emotion route	best direct audio	random guess
Eerola, 5 genres, in-domain, film level	**0.460**	0.396 (MusiCNN); VGGish 0.367	0.309
Eerola, 5 genres, in-domain, clip level	0.405	0.366 (VGGish)	0.307
Eerola, 5 genres, clip level, tuned thresholds	0.420	0.423 (VGGish)	0.307
Eerola, 8 genres, film level	0.349	0.257 (VGGish)	0.226
Eerola, 8 genres, clip level	0.317	0.278 (AST)	—
Eerola → Blockbuster, zero-shot	**0.508**	0.403 (VGGish)	0.292
Blockbuster → Eerola, 40 films	0.458	0.364 (VGGish)	0.240
Blockbuster, in-domain	0.616	0.621 (VGGish, majority vote)	0.295

Significance, in-domain (5 genres, film bootstrap): emotion vs VGGish p = 0.052, vs PCA-8 p = 0.089; over clips, Nadeau–Bengio p = 0.086 vs VGGish. Zero-shot: +0.106 [+0.021, +0.184], p = 0.013. Stability (clip level): SD over the 10 repeats 0.019 for the emotion route. Exact match of the most-frequent baseline: 0.283.